

Agrowinwin

Agricultural Investment Platform - Rural Producers and Diaspora Investors -Benin

01 PROBLEM

Context and Challenge

Agrowinwin connects small Beninese agricultural producers with individual investors (diaspora, young people), an agroecology specialist. Investors finance projects (1,000–3,000 €); funds are converted into inputs (organic fertiliser, seeds, labour) — never handed as cash. At harvest, the investor recovers capital plus a return. Five priority crop channels: rice, maize, soybean, cassava, pepper.

Core Problem Statement

Investors put money into agricultural projects but have no visibility into what happens on the ground. Without traceability on the platform, trust is fragile. Producers need inputs but have no access to formal credit - banks refuse them, NGOs are inconsistent. The platform also lacks legal framework, standard contracts, and an anti-abuse mechanism.

Identified UX Problems

01 Invisible Trust Between Investors and Producers

Investors cannot see where their money goes. Without real-time traceability, the relationship is built on faith alone — a major adoption barrier for diaspora investors.

02 Financial Flows Not Separated or Understood

Agrowinwin's roles are superposed. Investors don't understand how their money is protected, used, or what Agrowinwin's margin is.

03 Scalability Without Structured Governance

No legal framework, no standard contracts, no anti-abuse mechanism. If a producer doesn't reimburse, the entire platform reputation is at stake.

04 No Fertiliser Certification

The organic fertiliser produced by Agrowinwin has no market authorisation yet - blocking both technical credibility and commercial viability.

Methodology

Research combined coaching sessions , competitive mapping, and persona development from investor profiles and real producer prospecting (30 producers, 10 selected for pilot).

UX Competitive Analysis

UX Criterion	Rural Banks	NGOs / Grants	Crypto Platforms	Agrowinwin
Accessible Without Guarantee	✗	✓✓	✓	✓✓ Differentiator
Funds Converted to Inputs	✗	Partial	✗	✓✓ Unique model
Triple Impact (Eco/Env/Social)	✗	Partial	✗	✓✓ Differentiator
Real-Time Traceability	✗	✗	✓✓	✓ To build
Return on Investment	✗ (loan)	✗	✓✓	✓ Producer return
Protective Legal Framework	✓✓	✓✓	Partial	✗ → To build
Mandatory Agroecology	✗	Partial	✗	✓✓ Entry criterion

✓✓ = *Very good*

✓ = *Present*

✗ = *Absent*

User Personas

Émeka T. — Diaspora Investor Age: 31 · Engineer in France, Beninese origin · wants to diversify income and have impact Goal: Invest 1,500 € in a safe agricultural project with a 10–15% return Frustration: Mistrustful of African platforms without traceability. Previously lost money in an informal investment. UX Need: See in real time where money goes, receive regular reports, understand legal protection	Augustin H. — Rural Producer Age: 48 · Maize and soybean producer, rural Benin · 20 years experience Goal: Access quality inputs to double production without inaccessible bank loans Frustration: Banks won't lend. NGOs are inconsistent. He has land and know-how but no means. UX Need: Understand what he commits to, know his share vs. investor's share, receive technical support throughout the season
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Key UX Insights

Insight #1 - Fund-to-input traceability is the entire trust foundation

The most powerful trust-building mechanism is showing exactly how investor money becomes inputs on the ground. The chain (payment → inputs ordered → inputs delivered → field report) must be the central visual on the project page.

Insight #2 - Producer's share must be visible before commitment

Displaying 'Your share: X% - Investor share: Y%' on the producer onboarding screen, with a visible contract button, reduces the commitment anxiety that blocks sign-ups.

Insight #3 - Financial flow separation is essential for governance

Three separate ledgers — investor funds, Agrowinwin operating margin, and risk reserve - must be visible in the operator dashboard. Mixing them creates risk and opacity.

Insight #4 - The risk reserve must trigger automatic alerts

If the risk reserve drops below 10% of active funds, the operator must be alerted automatically. This prevents the platform from entering a coverage gap without notice.

User Flows — 3 Critical Journeys

Friction points were consistently identified around investor trust, producer qualification, and fund traceability.

Journey 1 — Diaspora Investor Discovery (network/LinkedIn) → Registration and verification → Chooses project → Validates investment → Real-time monitoring → Repayment + return

Journey 2 — Rural Producer Selected by Agrowinwin → Registration and criteria → Receives inputs → Season production → Technical monitoring → Repayment at harvest

Journey 3 — Agrowinwin Operator Producer qualification → Needs assessment → Funds converted to inputs → Field monitoring → Investor reports → Reserve and risk management

Design Decisions

Based on research and coaching insights, the following UX solutions were designed covering the homepage, the project card with full traceability, and the operator governance dashboard.

Hifi Prototypes

<https://zadya22.github.io/Agrowinwin/>

User Testing Protocol

Participants: 2 diaspora investors + 2 rural producers + 1 internal operator

Tool: Figma prototype

Duration: 30 min per session

#	Task	Focus Area
T1	You are a diaspora investor. Find a maize project, understand how your money is protected, and invest 1,500 €.	Investment flow and trust signals
T2	You are Augustin, producer. Understand what you receive, what you commit to, and accept the project.	Producer onboarding commitment
T3	You are the Agrowinwin operator. A producer hasn't sent a field report. Find his file and follow up.	Operator alert management
T4	Find the section explaining how funds are converted to inputs - never handed as cash to the producer.	Fund-to-input traceability
T5	From the operator dashboard, check the reserve balance and whether coverage is sufficient.	Financial governance check

Test Report - Key Findings

T1 - Diaspora Investment Success: 3/5	Investors didn't immediately understand their money is converted to inputs. They searched for a 'How it works' section that was unfindable. Recommendation: Add a 'Your funds in 3 steps' panel visible on the project card.
T2 - Producer Commitment Success: 2/5	The producer couldn't find what share of the harvest goes to the investor. The contract was mentioned but not visible. Recommendation: Display 'Your share: X % · Investor share: Y%' on the producer card. Add a 'Read the contract' button.
T4 - Funds → Inputs Success: 4/5	The explanation was present but buried in an FAQ. Most testers didn't find it without help. Recommendation: Move this to a dedicated section on the homepage and project card — it is the central differentiator.
T5 - Reserve Fund (Operator) Success: 5/5	No issues. The financial flow separation in the dashboard was understood and appreciated. Recommendation: Keep this format. Add an automatic alert if the reserve drops below 10% of active funds.
